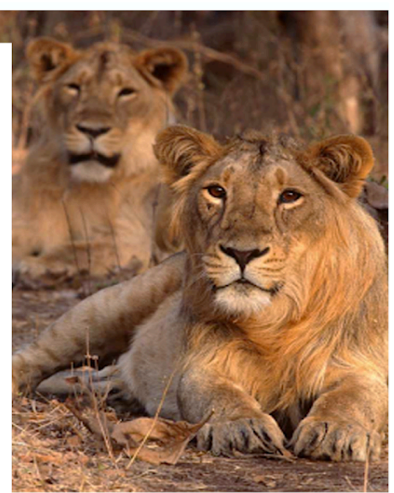
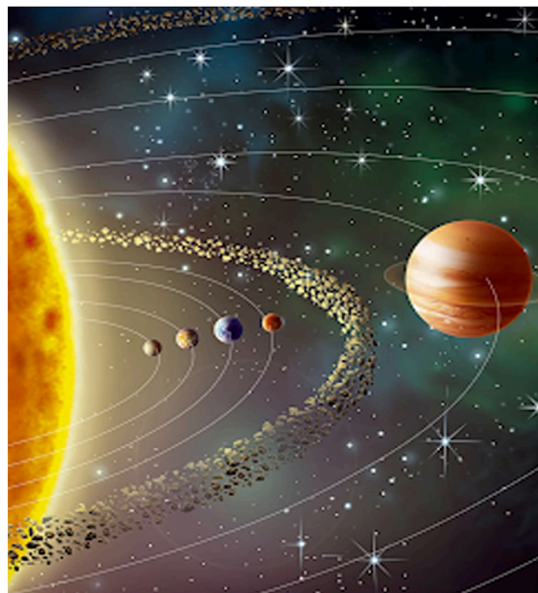
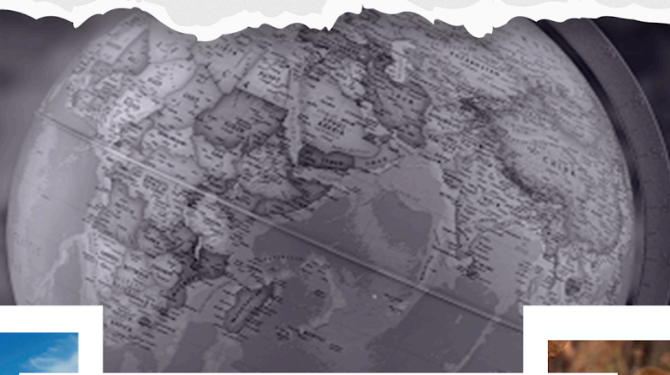


General Knowledge

World Geography

STUDY NOTES

Mapping: Plateaus



Mapping: Plateaus

Definition of a Plateau

A plateau is a **broad, flat-topped region** that is elevated above the surrounding land, often with one or more sides marked by steep slopes or escarpments.

Types of Plateaus

Plateaus are categorized based on their formation processes:

1. Intermontane Plateaus

- **Location:** Found between mountain ranges.
- **Formation:** Created by tectonic uplift or volcanic activity.
- **Examples:**
 - **Tibetan Plateau** (World's largest and highest plateau).
 - **Columbia Plateau** (USA).

2. Volcanic Plateaus

- **Formation:** Result from extensive lava flows that cover large areas, solidifying to form a flat surface.
- **Examples:**
 - **Deccan Plateau** (India).
 - **Snake River Plateau** (USA).

3. Erosional Plateaus

- **Formation:** Created by the erosion of surrounding areas, leaving the higher, flat region intact.
- **Examples:**
 - **Colorado Plateau** (USA).

4. Dissected Plateaus

- **Formation:** Formed by uplifting forces and then shaped by erosion from rivers and glaciers.
- **Examples:**
 - **Ozark Plateau** (USA).

5. Continental Plateaus

- **Location:** Found away from mountainous areas, covering extensive regions.
- **Formation:** Uplift of large sections of the Earth's crust.
- **Examples:**
 - **Katanga Plateau** (Africa).

Key Features of Plateaus

1. **Elevation:** Plateaus typically rise more than **300 meters** above the surrounding terrain.
2. **Flat or Undulating Surface:** While generally flat, some plateaus have rolling or gently sloping terrain.

3. **Steep Edges:** Many plateaus are bordered by **cliffs or escarpments**, making them distinct from the surrounding areas.
4. **Varied Climate:** Plateaus experience diverse climates, from arid in the Deccan Plateau to cold in the Tibetan Plateau.
5. **River Systems:** Plateaus are often dissected by rivers, which form deep **valleys or canyons** (e.g., Grand Canyon in the Colorado Plateau).
6. **Rich Resources:** Known for deposits of minerals like coal, iron, and manganese, as well as forests and fertile soils.

Significance of Plateaus

1. **Economic Importance:**
 - **Agriculture:** Fertile plateaus like the **Lava Plateau** in India support farming.
 - **Mining:** Rich in mineral deposits (e.g., **Chota Nagpur Plateau** in India).
 - **Hydropower:** Rivers originating in plateaus are harnessed for **hydropower generation**.
2. **Ecological Importance:**
 - Home to diverse **flora and fauna**.
 - Serve as **water catchment areas** for major river systems.
3. **Geographical Importance:**
 - Act as **climatic barriers**, influencing regional weather patterns.
4. **Tourism and Culture:**
 - Plateaus like the Tibetan Plateau and Colorado Plateau attract tourists for their unique landscapes and cultural significance.



Tibetan Plateau

- Location: **Central Asia**
- Known as the "**Roof of the World**".
- Surrounded by mountain ranges, including **Mount Everest** and **K2**.
- Formed by the **collision** of the **Indo-Australian** and **Eurasian tectonic plates**.

Columbia-Snake Plateau

- Location: **Washington, Oregon, and Idaho (USA)**
- Formed by **volcanic eruptions** and **basalt lava flows** (flood basalt plateau).

Colorado Plateau

- Location: **Southwestern USA**
- Bordered by:
 - **Rocky Mountains** (north and east)
 - **Great Basin** (west)
 - **Sonoran Desert** (south)

Deccan Plateau

- Location: **India**
- **The largest plateau in India.**
- Situated between the **Western Ghats** and the **Eastern Ghats**.
- Formed by **volcanic basalt deposits** during the **Deccan Trap eruptions**.

Kimberley Plateau

- Location: **Australia**
- Formed by **volcanic eruptions**.
- Rich in **mineral deposits**, including **kimberlite** (diamond-bearing rock) and traces of **oil**.

Katanga Plateau

- Location: **Democratic Republic of Congo**
- Renowned for **copper** and **uranium deposits**.
- Suitable for **farming** and **ranching**.

Mascarene Plateau

- Location: **Indian Ocean**
- **Second-largest undersea plateau** in the region (after the **Kerguelen Plateau**).
- Made of **granite**, a remnant of **Gondwana**.

Laurentian Plateau

- Location: **Canada**
- Also called the **Canadian Shield**.
- Features **Precambrian igneous** and **high-grade metamorphic rocks**.
- Rich in **iron ore deposits**.

Mexican Plateau

- Location: **Mexico**
- Known as the **Mexican Altiplano**.
- Called the "**Mineral Store**", housing abundant resources.
- Home to the **world's largest silver mine (Chihuahua)**.

Patagonian Plateau

- Location: **Argentina**
- A **semi-arid plateau** in the **rain shadow desert**.
- Famous for **sheep rearing**.

Altiplano Plateau

- Location: **Peru and Bolivia**
- Composed of **intermontane basins**.
- Known for its **tin reserves**.

Massif Central

- Location: **France**
- Created by **tectonic movements** and **faulting**.
- Famous for **grape cultivation**.

Anatolian Plateau

- Location: **Turkey**
- Also referred to as **Asia Minor**.
- Renowned for **Angora goats**, producers of **high-quality wool**.

Iberian Plateau

- Location: **Spain**
- Formed by **volcanic activity** and **lava flows**.
- Rich in **high-quality iron deposits**.

Loess Plateau

- Location: **China**

- Known as the **Huangtu Plateau**.
- Contains the **most erodible soil** in the world.

Pothohar Plateau

- Location: **Pakistan**
- Bounded by:
 - **Jhelum River** (east)
 - **Indus River** (west)
 - **Kala Chitta Range** (north)
 - **Salt Range** (south)

Bavarian Plateau

- Location: **Germany**
- Also called the **Alpine Foreland**.
- Formed under the **influence of ice ages**, creating diverse landforms.

Ahaggar Plateau

- Location: **Algeria**
- Also known as the **Hoggar Plateau**.
- Composed of **volcanic basalt**, situated in the **Sahara Desert**.